Stefan Herytash

sherytash.github.io

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Thyra Uth Thomsen, Head of Department, and the assessment committee
Department of Marketing
Copenhagen Business School
Solbjerg Plads 3
2000 Frederiksberg, Denmark

Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing

Dear Thyra Uth Thomsen and members of the assessment committee,

I apply for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing. I am an Assistant Professor at WU Vienna. I trained in mathematics at TU Wien and the University of Zurich, and took my PhD in Management, summa cum laude, at the Institute for Market-Based Management of LMU Munich, with a thesis on simulating human decision-making with large language models.

My paper *When and How to Integrate AI Simulations into Behavioral Experimentation* (Revise & Resubmit at the **International Journal of Research in Marketing**) measures how far answers written by a language model can replace consumers in a pre-test. I simulate 70 treatment effects from 30 published marketing studies at the level of the instrument: each synthetic respondent completes the original questionnaire in one randomized condition. Simulated and human effects correlate at $r = .73$, but the simulated effects come out at about two-fifths of the human magnitudes. They can rank ideas before a test is run; they cannot yet price them. In a many-analyst study forthcoming in the same journal, I was one of 156 analyst teams that estimated brand price elasticities from the same household panel data; the team averages range from −7.3 to +3.1. *After the Fax Machine Burns* (Submitted to **Management Science** as a Discussion Paper) develops a publication system in which every submission is published on arrival and graded afterward.

At WU I designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, in which students build and evaluate working agents; 95 % of the students recommend it. At LMU I raised over €100,000 in research funding for the institute from industry partners.

Post-training Makes Large Language Models Less Human-like (Under Review; one of 79 authors) introduces the Psych-201 dataset and finds that the stage that turns a base model into an assistant reduces its alignment with human behaviour. *Synthetic Participants Reproduce Effects They Cannot Replace* shows that however many synthetic respondents a study adds, it still needs the share $1 - \rho^2$ of its human respondents, where ρ is the correlation between a human's response and the simulator's response for that human. SimuLabs, the engine behind these papers, is open source. *Threshold Migration to the Patient* (Accepted at ANZAM 2026) follows a consumer wearable whose algorithm, not a clinician, now initiates triage.

Since August I have been negotiating a multi-year data partnership with kununu, the largest employer-review and salary platform in the German-speaking labour market. kununu shows a salary band only once enough employees have reported one, and the paper I am preparing estimates what that threshold does to applicant flows. *The Matching Cost of Pay Transparency* asks whether pay transparency changes whom firms hire; its formal model is complete, and the estimation with Revelio Labs data is in progress. At LMU I worked on Airbnb data and on predicting engagement with social media ads using machine learning. In a project I plan, a regression discontinuity at the rating threshold of Airbnb's Superhost badge, an average of 4.8, would separate the badge from the quality it is meant to signal.

At LMU Munich I taught the *Seminar on AI in Marketing* in 2024 and 2025, *Project Management* and the exercise sessions of *Marketing Management*, and at EM Lyon *Analyzing Markets*. As instructor, students rated me 10 out of 10 on average in *Project Management*

and 9 out of 10 in *Marketing Management*. This term I run the *Business Project* of WU's master's programme with Vienna Airport as corporate partner. At WU I also teach the AI sessions of the *Vienna Innovation Program*, an executive-level programme for North American Master of Business Administration students. I have supervised more than fifteen bachelor's and master's theses. I serve on WU's appointment committee for the Full Professor of Strategic Management, and I review for the Schmalenbach Journal of Business Research and four conferences. As a freelance consultant I ran market research and analytics for clients including Bayer and Allianz.

At CBS my benchmark would sit next to Felix Eggers' work on language-model valuations and design priors for choice experiments. The elasticity study meets the Digital Marketing Research Cluster's project on online promotions and customer value, and the kununu and Airbnb work its project on the platform economy. CogLab and the experiments.cbs.dk participant pool would let me run the simulated and the human version of the same study side by side on Danish samples; so far my benchmark compares simulations with published results. In Denmark I would like to approach Salling Group, the country's largest retailer, to estimate how its customers respond to prices and promotions, and Carlsberg, a partner of the department's Consumer Research Cluster, to compare simulated and human pre-tests of brand and pricing decisions. I would like to study the ratings of Trustpilot, the review platform founded in Denmark and based in Copenhagen, as a certification of the same kind as the Superhost badge, and to test the hiring question of the Matching Cost paper on Statistics Denmark's linked employer-employee registers through CBS. My first Danish application would go to the Independent Research Fund Denmark's thematic call Research on Artificial Intelligence, with a senior colleague from the department.

I will relocate to Copenhagen and be present in the department. I will learn Danish, which I am eager to do. At CBS I would offer a master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method, in which students test simulated respondents against human data; it would sit one level above the applied AI courses in the bachelor's programmes and the GMA summer school, and next to *Brand Analytics* in the EMF. Besides the elective, I will teach general marketing at bachelor's level again, as I did at LMU and EM Lyon, and I would like to teach in CBS's executive programmes. I will explain what my research means for society, both to the public and to CBS's partners in business, in talks for practitioners and through the interactive figures of my papers on my website. I will take on department and CBS-wide tasks. I will publish the data and code of each paper when it is published.

I can start on 1 September 2027. From January to March 2027 I am a Visiting Scholar at the Scandinavian Consortium for Organizational Research at Stanford. The application documents are also at `https://sherytash.github.io/for/cbs/`.

Sincerely,

Stefan Herytash